

Resume

Dinura Dissanayake

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EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University, USA <i>PhD in Computer Science (Supervised by Prof. Vishal Patel)</i>	August 2026 – Present
University of Peradeniya <i>Bachelor of Science of Engineering (Hons) in Computer Engineering</i>	Dec 2018 – Dec 2023 CGPA 3.75/4.00
• Bronze award in tertiary Student Projects in NBQSA 2023 (National ICT Awards)	

PUBLICATIONS

How Good are Foundation Models in Step-by-Step Embodied Reasoning?

- **Dinura Dissanayake**, Ahmed Heakl, Omkar Thawakar, Noor Ahsan, Ritesh Thawkar, Ketan More, Jean Lahoud, Rao Anwer, Hisham Cholakkal, Ivan Laptev, Fahad Shahbaz Khan, Salman Khan

All Languages Matter: Evaluating LLMs on Culturally Diverse 100 Languages - [CVPR 2025 Highlight](#)

- Ashmal Vayani, **Dinura Dissanayake**, Hasindri Watawana, Noor Ahsan, Omkar Thawakar, Aman Chadha, Hisham Cholakkal, Rao Muhammad Anwer, Michael Felsberg, Jorma Laaksonen, Tamar Solorio, Monojit Choudhury, Ivan Laptev, Mubarak Shah, Salman Khan, Fahad Khan

LlamaV-o1: Rethinking Step-by-step Visual Reasoning in LLMs - [ACL 2025 Findings](#)

- Omkar Thawakar, **Dinura Dissanayake**, Ketan More, Ritesh Thawkar, Ahmed Heakl, Jean Lahoud, Rao Muhammad Anwer, Hisham Cholakkal, Ivan Laptev, Mubarak Shah, Fahad Shahbaz Khan, Salman Khan

DriveLMM-o1: A Step-by-Step Reasoning Dataset and Large Multimodal Model for Driving Scenario Understanding - [IROS 2025 Oral Presentation](#)

- Ayesha Ishaq, Jean Lahoud, Ketan More, Omkar Thawakar, Ritesh Thawkar, **Dinura Dissanayake**, Noor Ahsan, Yuhao Li, Fahad Shahbaz Khan, Hisham Cholakkal, Ivan Laptev, Rao Muhammad Anwer, Salman Khan

Multimodal Deep Convolutional Neural Network Pipeline for AI-Assisted Early Detection of Oral Cancer - [IEEE Access](#)

- GAI Devindi, **DMDR Dissanayake**, SN Liyanage, FBAH Francis, MBD Pavithya, NS Piyarathne, PVKS Hettiarachchi, RMSGK Rasnayaka, RD Jayasinghe, RG Ragel, I Nawinne

A comprehensive dataset of annotated oral cavity images for diagnosis of oral cancer and oral potentially malignant disorders - [ScienceDirect Oral Oncology](#)

- NS Piyarathne, SN Liyanage, RMSGK Rasnayaka, PVKS Hettiarachchi, GAI Devindi, FBAH Francis, **DMDR Dissanayake**, RANS Ranasinghe, MBD Pavithya, IB Nawinne, RG Ragel, RD Jayasinghe

A Culturally-diverse Multilingual Multimodal Video Benchmark & Model - [EMNLP 2025 - Main Conference](#)

- Bhuiyan Sanjid Shafique, Ashmal Vayani, Muhammad Maaz, Hanoona Abdul Rasheed, **Dinura Dissanayake**, Mohammed Irfan Kurpath, et al.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Unified Vision-Language Action Model (2025)

- Exploring reasoning trace integration with Embodied Vision datasets (OpenX, BridgeV2) to enhance interpretability and step-wise decision-making in embodied AI tasks.

A Step-by-Step Reasoning Dataset and Large Multimodal Model for Driving Scenario Understanding (2025)

- Developed DriveLMM-o1, a benchmark and multimodal model to advance step-by-step visual reasoning for autonomous driving scenarios.
- Accepted to IROS 2025 as an Oral Presentation

Early Detection of Oral Cancer (2024)

- Research with a main focus of collecting an Oral Cavity dataset that is suitable for South Asian regions.
- Present a multimodal deep convolutional model to predict oral cancer using image and metadata.
- Neural Network Pipeline for AI-Assisted Early Detection of Oral Cancer published in IEEE Access
- A comprehensive dataset of annotated oral cavity images for diagnosis of oral cancer and oral potentially malignant disorders accepted as a journal paper as Oral Oncology.

End-to-End Planning-Oriented Autonomous Driving (2023)

- Improve already existing trajectory-guided control prediction method.
- Introduced depth information to the end to end system using the same monocular camera and introduced Model Predictive Control to the system.

EXPERIENCE

Mohamed Bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence	Apr 2024 – Present
<i>Research Engineer</i>	<i>Sept 2025 – Present</i>
• Supervisor: Prof. Fahad Khan, Dr. Salman Khan • Working on Multimodal reasoning, Cultural Understanding of Multimodal Models, and Embodied Vision	
<i>Research Associate</i>	<i>Apr 2024 – Aug 2025</i>
• Supervisor: Prof. Fahad Khan, Dr. Salman Khan • Working on Multimodal reasoning, Cultural Understanding of Multimodal Models, and Embodied Vision	
WSO2	Dec 2022 – May 2023
<i>Software Engineering Intern</i>	
• Created a GraphQL API to streamline Salesforce and Stripe payments.	
Department of Computer Engineering, University of Peradeniya, Sri Lanka	Aug 2021 – Oct 2022
<i>Volunteer Teaching Assistant</i>	
• Embedded Systems (CO321), Data Structures and Algorithms (CO322), Programming and Networking (CO253), Programming Methodology (CO222)	

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

Bronze Award NBQSA (National ICT Awards)	2023
• Won the bronze award at NBQSA 2023 in tertiary Student Projects (Technology) category	
2nd Place(Out of 100+ Teams) - ACES Coders V 9.0	2022
• Overnight inter-university coding competition organized by University of Peradeniya	
Top 300th World Among 6000+ Teams - IEEEEXTREME 16.0	2022
• 8th place in the country. • 24 hour competitive programming competition for university undergraduates worldwide.	
5th Place(Out of 100+ Teams) - MINI HACKATHON - ICDS	2021
• Data Science Hackathon organized by the University of Colombo • Developed a Bill checking mechanism using OCR.	
Bronze Medalist Sri Lankan Physics Olympiad	2017
• Organized by the Institute of Physics, Sri Lanka	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Programming Languages: Python, MATLAB, Java, C++, ARM Assembly, Verilog-HDL
- ML Libraries: PyTorch, OpenCV, Scikit-learn, Keras
- FPGA design and programming (C++)
- IoT: Node-RED, ESP32, MQTT

CLUB ACTIVITIES/ LEADERSHIP

AIESEC in University of Peradeniya, Sri Lanka

- Marketing Manager - Incoming Global Volunteer Sept 2021 - Feb 2022
- Business to Business Manager - Incoming Global Volunteer Mar 2021 - Aug 2021
- Team Leader - Incoming Global Volunteer Sept 2020 - Feb 2021

Music Society of University of Peradeniya

- Member Coordinator Sept 2021 - Sept 2022